

Communication Skills

Class Test - Complete Q&A Notes

Q1: The Seven C's of Effective Communication

The 7 C's are the principles that make communication effective:

- Completeness - Message must have all necessary info. Receiver should not need to ask follow-up questions.
- Conciseness - Say what you need without unnecessary words. Short and to the point.
- Consideration - Think about the receiver's perspective, emotions and needs. Empathy basically.
- Clarity - Use simple, specific words. One idea per sentence. No ambiguity.
- Concreteness - Be specific with facts and figures. 'Sales increased by 30%' not 'sales went up'.
- Courtesy - Respectful, polite tone. No rude or aggressive language.
- Correctness - No grammatical errors, accurate facts, proper format.

Q2: Why Memo is Used Outside the Organization?

Note: A memo is primarily an INTERNAL communication tool. For outside the organization, formal letters or emails are used.

What is a Memo?

A memo (memorandum) is a short, internal written communication used within an organization to pass information between departments, teams or employees.

Why it is used INSIDE:

- Quick and informal compared to a formal letter
- Used for announcements, reminders, policy updates, instructions
- No need for greetings or closings like formal letters
- Saves time in internal communication

For OUTSIDE communication - a Letter is used, not a memo. However, memos may be used with branches or subsidiaries for quick structured communication.

Q3: Verbal Communication, Presentation Techniques & Benefits

What is Verbal Communication?

Verbal communication is the use of spoken or written words to convey a message. It includes face-to-face conversations, phone calls, speeches, presentations, and meetings.

Importance:

- Fastest way to exchange information
- Allows immediate feedback

- Builds relationships and trust
- Resolves conflicts quickly

Presentation Techniques & Benefits:

- Eye Contact - Builds trust, holds attention
- Body Language - Makes message more convincing and clear
- Voice Modulation - Keeps audience interested, emphasizes key points
- Visual Aids (slides, charts) - Makes complex info easy to understand
- Pause & Pace - Gives audience time to absorb information

Example: A manager presenting quarterly results uses slides, maintains eye contact, and varies tone to keep the team engaged.

Q4: Principles of Effective Communication & Their Impact

- Clarity - Reduces misunderstandings in both personal and professional life
- Completeness - Leads to better decisions and fewer errors at workplace
- Conciseness - Saves time and keeps the listener/reader focused
- Feedback - Helps identify if message was understood correctly
- Empathy - Improves relationships and reduces conflict
- Active Listening - Avoids miscommunication and shows respect
- Appropriate Medium - Ensures message reaches the right person in the right way

Impact on Personal Life:

Better relationships, fewer arguments, more trust between people.

Impact on Professional Life:

Higher productivity, better teamwork, stronger leadership, fewer workplace conflicts.

Q5: Guidelines for Practicing Eye Contact

- Maintain Natural Eye Contact - Do not stare continuously. Look naturally and break occasionally.
- Follow the 3-5 Second Rule - Hold eye contact for 3-5 seconds then shift naturally.
- Include Everyone - In a group spread eye contact across the whole audience.
- Avoid Looking Down - Signals lack of confidence or nervousness.
- Do Not Look at Notes Too Much - Shows poor preparation, disconnects from audience.
- Match the Context - Formal settings = more controlled. Casual = more relaxed.
- Use Eye Contact to Show Interest - While listening, maintain eye contact to show engagement.
- Cultural Sensitivity - In some cultures direct eye contact is disrespectful. Know your audience.

Key Point: Too little = nervous. Too much = aggressive. Balance is key.

Q6: Feedback as an Important Component of Communication

What is Feedback?

Feedback is the response or reaction of the receiver after getting the message. It completes the communication cycle and makes it two-way.

Why Feedback is Important:

- Confirms Understanding - Tells sender if message was received correctly
- Reduces Miscommunication - Sender can immediately correct and clarify
- Improves Communication - Both parties improve over time
- Motivates the Sender - Positive feedback encourages better communication
- Makes Communication Two-Way - Without feedback, communication is just one-way broadcasting

Types of Feedback:

- Positive Feedback - Receiver agrees or appreciates
- Negative Feedback - Receiver disagrees or points out errors
- No Feedback - Silence or no response. Creates confusion.

Key Point: Feedback closes the loop and separates effective communication from a monologue.

Q7: Communication is the Lifeblood of a Business Organization

Just like blood keeps a body alive, communication keeps a business running. Without it, everything breaks down.

- Coordination Between Departments - HR, Finance, IT need to share information to work together
- Decision Making - Management needs accurate and timely info to make good decisions
- Employee Motivation - Clear communication of goals keeps employees productive
- Customer Relations - Builds loyalty and trust with clients
- Conflict Resolution - Clear communication prevents and resolves disputes
- Planning and Implementation - Every plan needs to be communicated for successful execution
- Leadership - A leader's effectiveness depends entirely on how well they communicate

Example: A software company launching a product needs communication at every level. One breakdown and the whole launch fails.

Q8: Difference Between Hearing and Listening

Hearing:

Hearing is a physical/biological process. It happens automatically whenever sound waves enter your ears. You do not have to try - it just happens.

Listening:

Listening is an active mental process. It requires focus, attention, and effort to understand, interpret, and respond to what is being said.

	Hearing	Listening
Nature	Passive	Active
Effort	No effort needed	Requires concentration
Understanding	No understanding	Full understanding
Choice	Involuntary	Voluntary
Purpose	Just receiving sound	Making meaning of sound

Key Point: Hearing is with your ears. Listening is with your mind.

Q9: Why Listening is Essential for Effective Communication

- Ensures Accurate Understanding - Without proper listening you miss key details
- Builds Trust and Respect - The speaker feels valued and respected
- Avoids Miscommunication - Most conflicts happen because someone did not listen properly
- Improves Problem Solving - You can only solve a problem if you fully understand it
- Makes You a Better Communicator - People who listen well also speak better

In Personal Life:

Strengthens bonds, resolves conflicts, shows emotional intelligence.

In Professional Life:

Improves productivity, reduces errors, shows professionalism.

Key Point: Communication is 50% speaking and 50% listening.

Q10: Why Attentive Listening is Important at Public Places

- Safety Information - Announcements may include emergency alerts or evacuation instructions
- Travel Information - Gate changes, platform changes, delays communicated through announcements
- No Repetition Guarantee - Unlike a classroom, nobody will repeat the announcement
- Noisy Environment - Must actively focus and filter out background noise
- Time Sensitivity - Information is urgent and time-bound requiring immediate action
- Consequences of Not Listening - Missing a flight, wrong platform, security issues

Key Point: In public transport settings, attentive listening is a necessity not just courtesy.

Q11: Difference Between a Letter and a Memo

Letter:

A formal written document used to communicate OUTSIDE the organization - with clients, customers, other companies, government bodies.

Memo:

A short informal written document used to communicate INSIDE the organization - between departments, employees, or management.

	Letter	Memo
Used	Outside organization	Inside organization
Tone	Formal	Semi-formal/informal
Format	Has salutation and closing	No salutation or closing
Length	Can be long	Short and concise
Examples	Client proposal, job offer	Meeting reminder, policy update

Key Point: Letter goes OUT of the organization. Memo stays IN the organization.

Q12: Why Clarity of Voice is Important in Telephone Communication

Telephone communication is purely audio-based. There is no body language, no facial expressions, no visual cues. Your voice is the ONLY tool you have.

- No Visual Support - If your voice is unclear the entire message is lost
- Avoids Misunderstanding - Mumbling leads to wrong information being received
- Builds Professionalism - A clear confident voice creates a positive impression
- Saves Time - If you speak clearly the first time, no need for repetition
- Handles Network Issues - Clear voice ensures message gets through despite technical issues

Tips for Clarity:

- Speak at moderate pace
- Pronounce words clearly
- Avoid filler words like 'umm' or 'uh'
- Speak directly into the phone
- Avoid noisy environments

Key Point: On telephone, your voice IS your personality.

Q13: Three Main Parts of an Essay

1. Introduction

The opening paragraph. Introduces the topic, provides background context, and ends with a thesis statement - the main argument of the essay.

Purpose: Hook the reader and tell them what the essay is about.

2. Body

The middle and longest part. Contains multiple paragraphs each discussing one main idea. Each paragraph has a topic sentence, supporting details, and a concluding sentence.

Purpose: Develop and prove your argument with details and examples.

3. Conclusion

The final paragraph. Summarizes main points and restates the thesis in different words. No new information is introduced here.

Purpose: Wrap up the essay and leave a lasting impression.

Simple formula: Introduction = Tell them what you will say. Body = Say it. Conclusion = Tell them what you said.

Q14: How Precis Writing Differs from Summarizing

	Summary	Precis
Length	No fixed length	Exactly 1/3 of original
Style	Flexible, casual	Formal and strict
Point of View	Can include opinion	Strictly objective
Format	No fixed format	Follows strict format
Title	Not required	Always has a title

Rules of Precis Writing:

- Must be exactly one third of original length
- Written in third person
- Past tense throughout
- No personal opinions or examples added
- Must have a suitable title
- Only main ideas, no extra details

Key Point: Both shorten a text but precis is the strict, formal, rule-bound version. Summary is flexible.

Q15: Purpose of Note-Making During Lectures or Reading

- Aids Memory - Notes give you a written record to refer back to later
- Improves Concentration - Actively taking notes keeps you focused

- Saves Time During Revision - Quickly revise from concise notes instead of re-reading chapters
- Develops Understanding - Writing in your own words forces you to process information
- Organizes Information - Structures complex information into clear logical points
- Useful for Future Reference - Personal study resource usable anytime
- Improves Writing Skills - Improves ability to identify key points

Effective Note-Making Tips:

- Use headings and subheadings
- Use abbreviations and symbols
- Write in point form not full sentences
- Review notes soon after the lecture

Key Point: Note-making is an active learning tool that improves understanding, retention, and academic performance.

Q16: Sample Memo - IT Manager to All Employees

MEMORANDUM

TO: All Employees

FROM: IT Manager, Information Technology Department

DATE: March 29, 2026

SUBJECT: Scheduled System Maintenance - Saturday, 9 AM to 5 PM

This is to inform all employees that scheduled system maintenance will be carried out this Saturday from 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM.

During this period, email services will be completely unavailable. All employees are requested to plan their work accordingly and ensure that any urgent emails are sent before 9:00 AM on Saturday.

We apologize for the inconvenience caused. This maintenance is necessary to improve system performance and ensure smooth operations going forward.

For any urgent communication during the maintenance window, please use telephone or reach out to your department head directly.

Your cooperation is highly appreciated.

IT Manager

Information Technology Department

Key Format Points:

- Memo has TO, FROM, DATE, SUBJECT at the top

- No 'Dear Sir/Madam' - memos do not have salutations
- No 'Yours sincerely' - memos do not have formal closings
- Short, clear, professional body

Q17: Process Diagram of Communication

Draw the following boxes in a horizontal line with arrows between them:

Step	Component	Description
1	Sender	Source who initiates the message
2	Encoding	Converting thoughts into words or symbols
3	Channel	Medium used - email, phone, face-to-face
4	Decoding	Receiver interpreting the message
5	Receiver	The target who receives the message
6	Noise	Anything that disrupts communication
7	Feedback	Receiver's response back to sender

Diagram: Sender -> Encoding -> Channel -> Decoding -> Receiver

Add NOISE above the Channel box and a FEEDBACK arrow looping from Receiver back to Sender below the diagram.

Q18: Resume & Covering Letter - Technical Manager Post

COVERING LETTER

Your Name

Your Address, City, Country

Email | Phone

Date

The HR Manager

[Software Company Name]

[Company Address]

Subject: Application for the Post of Technical Manager

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to apply for the position of Technical Manager at your esteemed organization. I am confident that my technical expertise, leadership experience, and project management skills make me a strong candidate for this role.

I hold a degree in Computer Science and have over five years of experience in software development and team management. Throughout my career I have successfully led cross-functional teams, managed end-to-end software projects, and ensured timely delivery within budget. I am well-versed in agile methodologies, system architecture, and client communication.

I am particularly drawn to your organization because of its reputation for innovation and technical excellence. I believe my skills and dedication align well with your goals.

I have enclosed my resume for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application further at your convenience.

Yours sincerely,

[Your Name]

RESUME

[YOUR FULL NAME]

Email: email@example.com | Phone: +92-XXX-XXXXXXX | Karachi, Pakistan

Objective

A results-driven IT professional seeking the position of Technical Manager to utilize leadership, technical, and project management skills in a dynamic software environment.

Education

BSc Computer Science - [University Name] - 20XX to 20XX

Work Experience

Senior Software Engineer | [Company Name] | 20XX - Present

- Led a team of 8 developers on enterprise-level projects
- Managed project timelines, deliverables, and client communication
- Implemented agile workflows reducing delivery time by 30%

Software Developer | [Company Name] | 20XX - 20XX

- Developed and maintained web applications
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams on product design

Skills

- Team Leadership & Project Management
- System Architecture & Design
- Agile / Scrum Methodology
- Client Communication

- Programming: Java, Python, JavaScript

Certifications

- PMP - Project Management Professional
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect

References

Available upon request